

Clutch Certified. Messaging Hierarchy

Internal reference · Campaign 2026 · Clutch Creative



New webpage for reference <https://clutch-new.vercel.app/clutch-certified/v3.html>

Question	The Line	The Proof
What It Is		
What is Clutch Certified?	<i>"Only the best cars become Clutch Certified."</i>	Every car we sell on our site has to meet our strict standards before it is Clutch Certified and listed for sale. It's a standard that only the best cars achieve. Clutch Certified cars are inspected, road-tested, serviced and signed off by real Clutch mechanics before you ever see it.
What does it actually mean?	<i>"Clutch Certified means your car has been inspected, serviced, detailed, and certified in person by a Clutch mechanic. Every car. No exceptions."</i>	Our 210-point inspection is just the beginning, it's not the whole story. It goes through comprehensive servicing: anything that needs fixing, replacing, or reconditioning gets done. Only once it meets our high standards is it Clutch Certified. It's then detailed and photographed inside and out. The full process: • 210-point inspection by real Clutch mechanics; 21 mechanics, 42 pairs of eyes • Road tested by 3 independent mechanics • If it passes; parts fixed, replaced, or reconditioned to meet the standard • Then, and only then, it's Clutch Certified • Photographed and detailed inside and

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		out, what you see online is exactly what you get
Is every car on clutch Clutch Certified?	<i>"Every car you see on Clutch is certified."</i>	Yes. If it's on the site, it's certified. If it didn't pass, our inspection it isn't here. That's the whole point of Clutch Certified, it's not optional, and it's excessively selective by choice.
The Standard		
Who certifies the cars?	<i>"Our own real Clutch mechanics, working on-site, every time."</i>	Clutch mechanics, employed by Clutch, working in our own facility, conducting the road tests, inspection and servicing.
What does the inspection actually cover?	<i>"210 points. 5 specific inspection stations. Nothing skipped."</i>	The 210-point inspection covers mechanical, safety, and cosmetic condition across every major system — engine, brakes, suspension, electrical, tires, bodywork, and more. It runs across 5 inspection stations: • Submission — initial assessment • Full inspection — all 210 points • Safety — dedicated safety check • QC — quality control review • Pre-delivery — final sign-off before the car reaches you
How many people worked on the car?	<i>"23 Clutch mechanics. 46 pairs of eyes. Every car."</i>	Every Clutch Certified car is handled by a minimum of 23 Clutch mechanics across 5 specific stations of inspection. That's 46 pairs of eyes on one car, before it reaches you. Why it matters: This isn't a visual once-over. It's a structured, multi-stage process with multiple Clutch mechanics responsible for signing off at each stage.
What happens after a car passes inspection?	<i>"Passing inspection is just the beginning."</i>	Once a car clears the 210-point inspection, the work isn't done. Cars that pass move through our servicing process: anything that needs to be replaced, fixed, or brought

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		up to our standard gets done, multiple Clutch mechanics all working to our certification standards. Then it's detailed and photographed meticulously. Showing every detail, so what you see online is exactly what you get no surprises. Only after inspection, reconditioning and detailing does the car earn the exclusive Clutch Certified badge.
What happens to cars that didn't pass?	<i>"If it's not the best, it doesn't get listed. Simple."</i>	60% of cars we buy don't get Clutch Certified. If they do not make it through our 210-point inspection and are immediately removed from the production process. They do not go on our site. Our Clutch Certified standard isn't negotiable, and it does not change. Framing note <i>Lead with what the car earned, not what got rejected. Our pass rate proves the standard, it's not a rejection story.</i>
How It Compares		
How does it compare to CPO?	<i>"Our standards exceed most CPO programs, and we can prove it."</i>	CPO standards vary by dealer. Some are rigorous, however most are not. Clutch Certified is our own standard, and every part of it is documented and can be viewed on our site. • Brake pads: 3.2mm minimum — double Ontario's legal requirement of 1.6mm • Tire tread: 4mm minimum — above most CPO programs; double the legal minimum • Every car: road tested by 3 independent mechanics. Not just visual inspection • Free CARFAX vehicle history report

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		We didn't set these high numbers because anyone asked us to. We set them because for us, this is the right standard.x
How is it different from buying new?	<i>"You get the best quality and value on the market, without the new car price."</i>	Buying new gets you the newest car but it also comes with a hefty price tag. Clutch Certified is for people who want the highest standard of pre-owned quality without paying a new car price. % stat on how much cheaper a 2 year old car is
How is it different from a private seller?	<i>"A private seller tells you what they know. We tell you what we found."</i>	Private sellers disclose what they're aware of. Clutch mechanics find what you wouldn't know to look for, hidden rust, frame issues, brake wear, tire depth below standard. 42 pairs of eyes found all working through our 210-point inspection. Plus it comes with full accident history and carfax report. that's the difference.
Buying With Confidence		
Why is selectivity a good thing for me?	<i>"We only sell the best of the best, and that start's with identifying the best used cars in the market."</i>	"Only 40% of the cars we buy from the public make it through Clutch Certification. The fact that most don't is exactly why we stand by offering the best cars.
10 days to love it or return it, what does that mean?	<i>"Love it in 10 days, or return it. That's Clutch Certified."</i>	Buying a car is a big decision and a 15-minute test drive cannot give you a real sense of wether it's the perfect car for you. With Clutch, you have 10 days to decide if the car you chose, really is the one for you and fits your lifestyle. Drive it, go on roadtrip with the family, take it on your daily commute. If it's not right, for any reason, we'll take it back. No awkward conversations. No conditions buried in fine print.

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		Why we offer this. The 10-days or 750km return isn't a safety net for us. It's peace of mind for you.
What if I wake up and it just doesn't feel right?	<i>"If you don't love it, we'll take it back. 10 day Money back. No questions."</i>	That's the deal. You don't need a mechanical reason. You don't need to find a defect. If you wake up on day 3 and it's not the right car for you, bring it back. We built the standard so you never have to worry about the car itself. If the feeling isn't there, that's enough.

Sales

Key Phrases	Why	Guidance
Clutch Certified	As we move to establish our car quality above used/CPO an just below new, we are setting a new category called Clutch Certified cars.	Every car we sell will now be referred to as clutch Certified. Meaning our packages are changing name, see below.
Clutch Mechanics / Real Mechanics	Customers are often unaware that we have our own mechanics working on vehicles in Canadas largest reconditioning facility.	Do not say Clutch 'certified' mechanics, only Clutch Mechanics.
Every car you see on Clutch is certified. If it doesn't pass our inspection, it never gets listed and you will never see it on our site.	Customers may question what happens to the cars that fail our inspection and may have fears that we list both Clutch Certified and non-certified/failed cars.	Assure them that we only sell the best cars, only clutch Certified vehicles make it to our site. Anything that didn't pass our inspection is immediately taken out of the production process and is never listed for sale on our site.
23 Mechanics inspected, serviced and worked on	Customers have no idea just how many people have worked on this car, we have	8 mechanics have inspected the vehicle, and in total through to servicing its a total

Key Phrases	Why	Guidance
each car, that's 46 pairs of eyes	tested revealing this number to customers and they are both impressed and surprised, giving them a boost of confidence in our quality.	of 23. Mention this to customers
The most rigorous car inspection in the industry.	We hang our hat on only selling the best cars, that means we are incredibly selective.	With 5 dedicated inspection stations, 210 points inspected, 8 mechanics checking every vehicle, and a full CarFax report shared, nothing is missed.
3 independent, Clutch mechanic led road-tests	Customers want tests drives, we primarily offer peace of mind through our 10 day love it or return it policy, but they also can rest assured that we have 3 mechanic led road tests throughout our process to ensure quality.	

Step	What to Say	Why It Works
Step 1 Only the best	<i>"We hang our hat on selling the best used cars in Canada. Less than half the cars we own make it through our industry leading inspection process."</i>	Set the tone straight out of the gate that we only sell the best cars. Confidence is high and from this point on their should be no surprises or wavering of confidence in regards to quality.
Step 2 Make it real	<i>"Every car goes through a 210-point inspection by real Clutch mechanics, 21 of them, 42 pairs of eyes. If it passes, it moves into our extensive servicing stations: anything that needs replacing or fixing gets done to the highest standards. Then it's detailed, Certified, photographed and</i>	Passing inspection isn't the finish line, it's the entry point. Laying out the full sequence (inspect → service → detail → Certification → photograph → list) makes the standard tangible. It's not just a badge. It's a process.

Step	What to Say	Why It Works
	<i>finally, earns it's place on our site. That's the full process."</i>	
Step 3 Remove the risk	<i>"And even after all of that, when you get the car home you have 10 days to see how it fits into your life, if for any reason you change your mind or it's not the one, you can return it. No questions asked, full money back guarantee."</i>	The last objection killer. Frame it as confidence, not generosity — it lands differently. The return window is the proof the standard is real.
If asked vs. CPO	<i>"CPO standards differ from dealer to dealer, some are strict, and some are not. Our brake and tire standards are double the legal requirement and we publish the history and inspection report for all our Clutch Certified cars. We didn't have to set that high bar. We chose to."</i>	Don't attack. State the facts. Specificity wins, the numbers make the comparison without us having to say "we're better."

Package Renaming



Changing names: All cars will now be referred to as Clutch Certified, therefore the packages we offer will need name changes. We will be moving our two top tier packages to the Clutch Care tier.

Original Name	Updated	Rationale
BASIC	BASIC	
ESSENTIAL	ESSENTIAL	
CLUTCH CERTIFIED	CLUTCH CARE	
CLUTCH CERTIFIED +	CLUTCH CARE COMPLETE	Feels well rounded and also helps create intrigue from tier 3 to 4

Reasoning: *"Complete sounds like I'm getting the full thing. Just 'ClutchCare' sounds like... I'm not getting the full thing." But it never says "you're unprotected" or "you're missing out." It's entirely positive framing, the upper tiers add confidence, the lower tier doesn't remove anything.*

Language Guide

Use these	Never say these
• Clutch Certified • Industry leading inspection • Thorough • Rigorous • Servicing (as the umbrella for reconditioning) • Reconditioned or Replaced • Certified by a Clutch Mechanics • Mechanic-led road test • 23 mechanics worked on every car = 46 pairs of eyes • If it doesn't pass our inspection, it immediately gets removed from the Clutch production process and is never listed on our site. • 10 days to love it or return it • If you don't love it, you have 10 days to return it, no questions asked	• Pre-owned • Test drive (say mechanic-led road test) • Dealership / dealer / lot • Don't miss out • Act now • Certified Mechanic (say real mechanic or Clutch Mechanic. Certified is for vehicles) • Fixed

What We're Shifting

Before	After
Clutch = easy to buy online	Clutch = a car you can genuinely trust
Convenient	Certified
Used Cars	Clutch Certified Cars

CTA's

Conversion:

Copy	Intent
Shop Certified	High — browse/shop
Browse Certified	High — browse
Buy Certified	High — purchase
Shop Clutch Certified	Mid — browse/shop
Find Your Car	Mid — discovery

Shop Certified

Browse Certified

Buy Certified

Shop Clutch Certified

Find you car